proven war horse, Bogey Sen, was champing at the bit to take on the Chinese.

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Headquartered at Shillong was XXXIII Corps, and the first inkling Army HQ would get of the situation on the ground was when the BGS, Brigadier Jagjit Singh Aurora, rang up the DMO and demanded to know why such unreasonable orders were emanating from Delhi. Aurora was emphatic that the brigade, the division and the corps were consistently advising against any offensive action across the Nam Ka Chu that had now become the de facto boundary between Chinese and Indian troops. Obviously, while the orders were flowing directly from Army HQ to the various field formations, their appreciations and replies were being routed through the chain of command and not progressing beyond Eastern Command. The matter was discussed with the officiating CGS, who felt that the GOC Eastern Command had far more operational experience under his belt than the corps commander and that his advice on the issue had to be followed.

The failure to move forward and push the Chinese back over the Thagla Ridge on 19 September was being interpreted by the Eastern Army Commander, Bogey Sen, as insubordination. He was making it known to the GOC XXXIII Corps, Lieutenant General Umrao Singh, in no uncertain terms, that he felt that GOC 4 Division, Major General Niranjan Prasad, and commander 7 Brigade, Brigadier John Dalvi, were both dragging their feet.

Eastern Command, now with the backing of the government's explicit orders to evict the Chinese, ordered XXXIII Corps to prepare an offensive plan. Umrao Singh now had no choice but to task Niranjan Prasad to move immediately on foot to Lumpu, which he reached on 25 September after an exhausting trek. Prasad was obviously under tremendous pressure, for he had also initially endorsed Dalvi's decision to countermand the Army HQ order to capture Thagla by 19 September. But now the plan for evicting the Chinese by a stipulated D-Day was dominating all thinking. He was acutely aware that unless he could convince Dalvi to produce an appreciation that could be deemed as an attack plan, both he and Dalvi would be branded as cowards.

After reaching Lumpu, Prasad immediately ordered 9 Punjab to move its Delta Company at Bridge 1 to Tsangle, which was across Bridge 5 at the